REACTION PAPER

Objectives

2. Identify the techniques in writing effective reaction paper; and

1. demonstrate understanding of the significance of writing a reaction paper to society

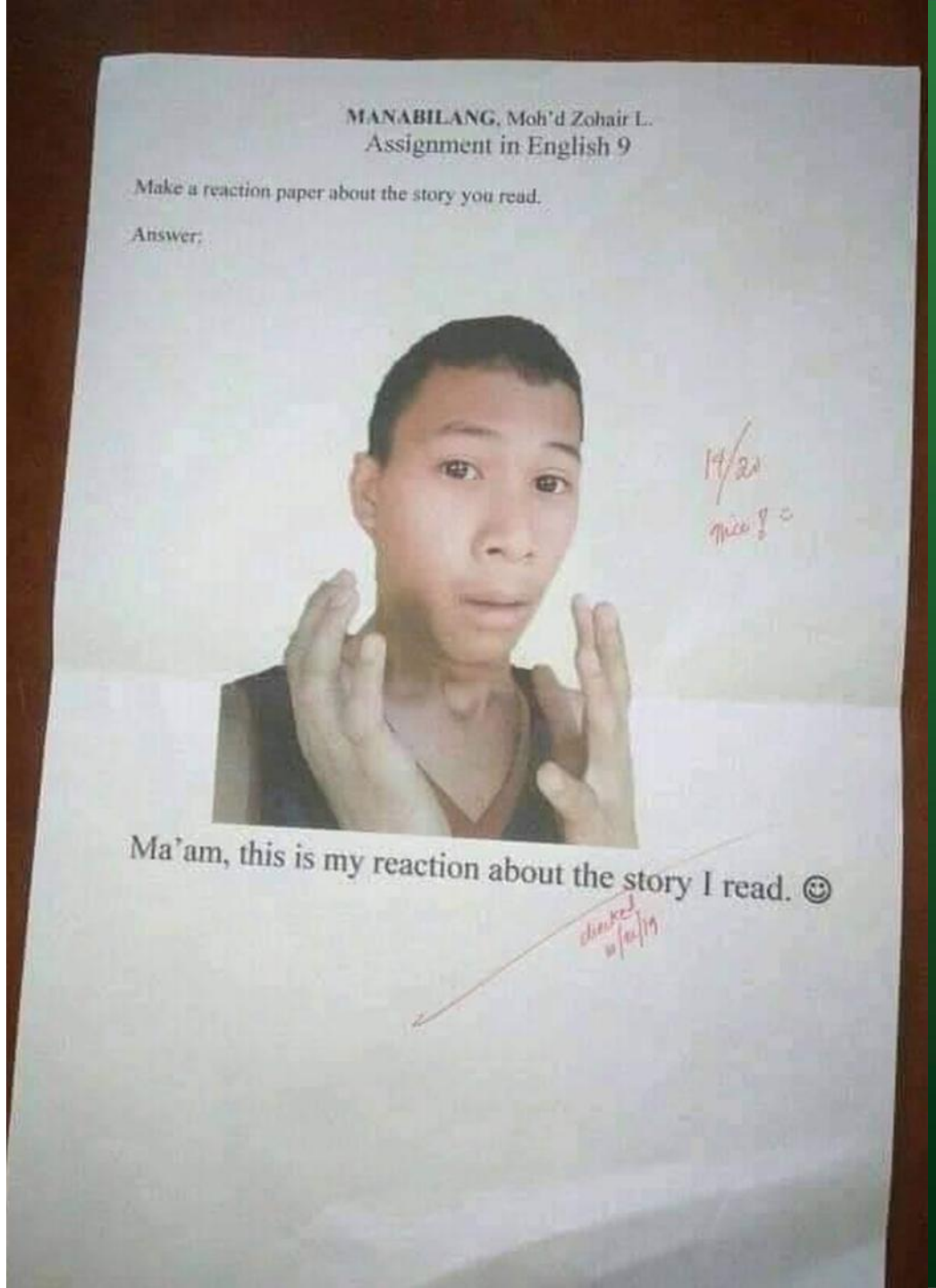
3. write an objective or balanced review or critique of a work of art, an event, or a program.

What is a Reaction Paper?

1

A reaction paper is an essay in which you describe the emotions a certain person, object or event caused in you. It is not only an expression of your emotion, but a reaction paper is a type of academic paper that requires ability to present thoughts and ideas in a scholarly manner.

Writing a reaction paper typically involves providing a commentary on a specific article, journal, or book. To do this effectively, you must remain critical and develop your thoughts while reading.



Things to consider...

1

Identification

Pinpoint specific points you wish to argue, discuss, or expand upon. This shall be your thesis statement, around which your whole paper will revolve.

The reaction paper's content should be interesting and thought-provoking. This means moving beyond the statement "I liked it" or "I didn't like it". This requires you to engage with the material in a deeper and critical way.

Stand

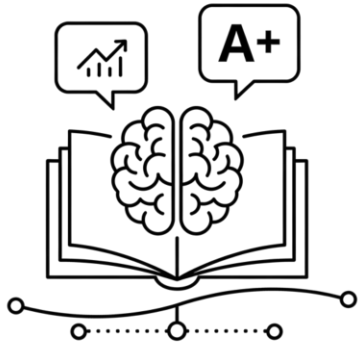
You may choose to agree and add interesting insights or completely disagree by explaining why an author's point is flawed. This will be the body of your reaction paper, where you will cite the author and defend your stand.

When should we write a reaction paper?

2

Creative Works

Films
Arts
Literature
Drama



Academic

Books
Research Articles

Media Content

News
Feature Stories
Social media content and exchanges

What are the purposes of writing a reaction paper?

Professional Self-Expression

- It helps students develop the ability to express their thoughts in an academic and professional manner

Focused Insight

- Reaction papers allow students to explore one specific aspect of a larger subject. By focusing on a narrow case study, students gain a deeper insight

What are the purposes of writing a reaction paper?

Skill Demonstration

- The process serves as a platform for students to demonstrate three essential pillars of education: the ability to research, understand, and communicate information.

Demonstration of Mastery

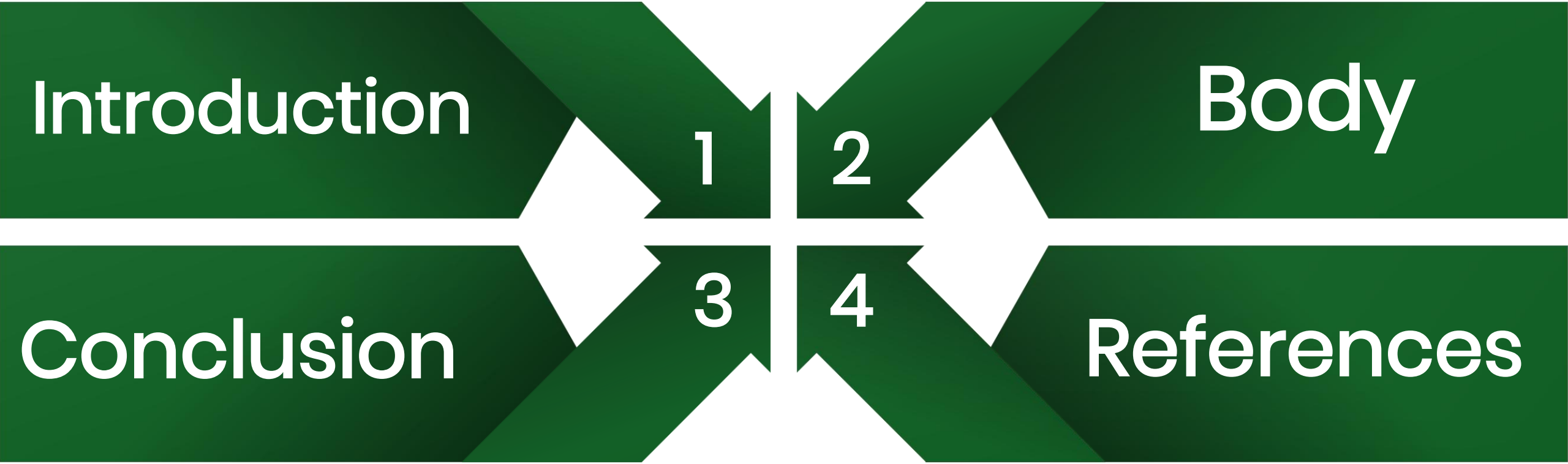
- It provides an opportunity for students to show they have mastered the course material and can exercise their verbal and written skills effectively.

What are the purposes of writing a reaction paper?

Personal Input

- Unlike some purely objective reports, a reaction paper encourages students to have personal input and share their own opinions in the conclusion.

What are the parts of a reaction paper?



Introduction

This is where you briefly introduce the material by stating the title and the author. Highlight the main points and its key supporting points. Present a definitive statement that summarizes your reaction and core argument.

Body

- Lead with a topic sentence
- Provide evidence
- Analyze the connection
- Conclude with evaluation

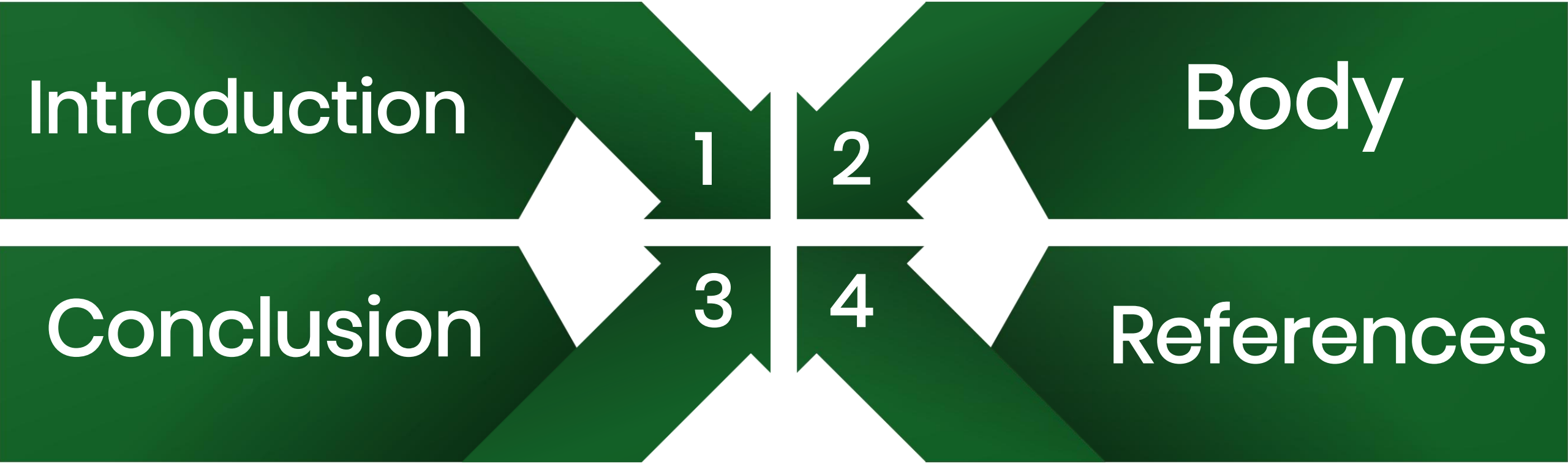
Conclusion

- Restate your thesis statement
- Summarize key points
- Provide final thoughts

References

- Cite every source
- Prioritize scholarly evidence
- Provide reliable references
- Respect intellectual property

Parts of a Reaction Paper

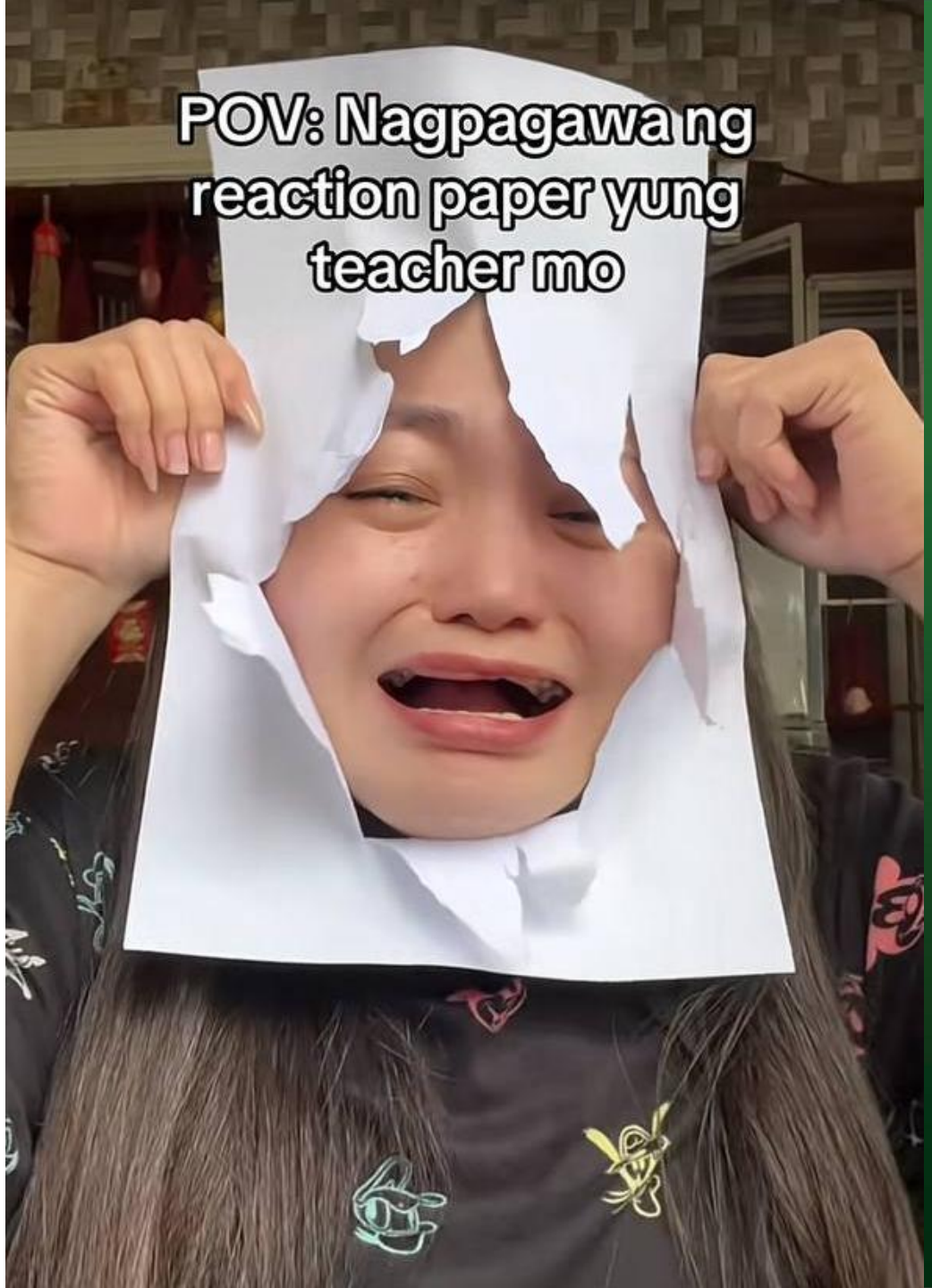


Principles on Writing Good Reaction Paper

3

Objectivity and Balance:
A good reaction paper touches on both a work's strengths and weaknesses, as well as its advantages and disadvantages.

Comprehensiveness
While you should consult multiple resources to support your claims, you are also expected to remain concise and focused in your reaction paper.



Principles on Writing Good Reaction Paper

3

Constructiveness:

While the strengths of a work are normally sought after in critiques, identifying weaknesses is equally important. Since weaknesses highlight areas for improvement, you should offer constructive points for a more favorable outcome instead of simply labeling a work as 'bad'.

Conciseness and Clarity:

Reaction paper should be clearly constructed. Avoid unnecessary phrases, especially when content is focused on evaluating works.

Correctness and Completeness:

Follow the prescribed formats and present correct information.

Tips in Writing a Reaction Paper

4

Preparation

Begin by creating a detailed outline. This helps you identify your various reactions, organize supporting evidence (justifications), and ensures the paper stays on the right track.

I. Introduction:
   A. Opening statements (to engage the reader and introduce the topic):
   B. Thesis statement:

II. (Body) First supporting point (topic sentence):
   A. Evidence 1: Paraphrase (with citation):
   B. Evidence 2: Paraphrase (with citation):
   C. Evidence 3: Paraphrase (with citation):

III. (Body) Second supporting point (topic sentence):
   A. Evidence 1: Paraphrase (with citation):
   B. Evidence 2: Paraphrase (with citation):
   C. Evidence 3: Paraphrase (with citation):

IV. (Body) Third supporting point (topic sentence):
   A. Evidence 1: Paraphrase (with citation):
   B. Evidence 2: Paraphrase (with citation):
   C. Evidence 3: Paraphrase (with citation):

V. Conclusion:
   A. Final analysis or interpretation of main point:
   B. Ending comment (an opinion, a prediction, a recommendation, etc):

Tips in Writing a Reaction Paper

Introduction

Start with a summary of the work that is at least three sentences long. It must include the title and author, ending with a strong thesis statement at the conclusion of the paragraph.

Body Paragraphs

Focus each paragraph on a single, concise reaction. State your point clearly and follow it with supporting reasons or observations from the text. Use "personal indicators" like "I believe..." or "In my opinion..." to distinguish your voice.

Tips in Writing a Reaction Paper

Conclusion

Wrap up the paper by restating your thesis and summarizing your main reactions. To leave a lasting impact, consider ending with a challenge to the readers.

4

Read and analyze.

It is important to read the material in a deep and analytical manner. Doing so will help you develop an effective reaction piece that you can support and justify later. You should also identify a major point or thesis that you want to center your paper around. Additionally, taking notes during the reading process is essential, as it provides a reliable reference when you begin drafting your paper.

Tips in Writing a Reaction Paper

4

Contextualize

You can also incorporate at least one real-life example to make it easier to explain and justify your stance.

What's the Sense of The Sixth Sense?

By: Camille Anjela Curitana

1. The Sixth Sense is often regarded as one of the classic thrillers in film history. Produced under the direction of M. Night Shyamalan, it tells the story of how the child psychologist Malcolm Crowe (Bruce Willis) helps the boy Cole Sear (Haley Joel Osment) to cope with day-to-day life as the latter is often ridiculed for claiming to see dead people a few months after the former was shot by a former patient who ended up being more depressed than ever. Determined to redeem himself from his failure with the depressed patient, Crow does everything within his power to help Cole Sear only to encounter a shocking revelation about himself at the end of it all.

2. Being a thriller, one would expect its plot to have surprising twists and turns. Nonetheless, right from the very onset, the supposed twist of the film is already a giveaway and this somehow defeats the very purpose of the movie. **Despite Willis' and Osment's great acting and the eerie and often depressing production design, I really do not think that *The Sixth Sense* should even be labeled as a thriller, for there is nothing to be thrilled about in the first place.**

3. As expected, veteran actor Bruce Willis once again delivers his part well. His often confused looks, persistent spirit, and calm, reassuring voice all fit the description of a typical psychologist. This is rightly complemented with Osment's unpredictable fits. At times, Osment would look like a very calm, self-assured young boy, but whenever he would throw a fit, he would start shouting and shaking as if he were really going mad.

4. Such a good acting is also packaged in a relatively dismal production design. There is no background music to match the depressing sets such as Willis' home (which is often portrayed as dark), the small apartment where Cole Sear stayed, and even the hospital's eerie silence. Just like any old-fashioned thriller, this silence is occasionally broken by ghostly apparitions of sorts which many in the movie claim as unreal.

5

5. Nonetheless, the acting and production design are all for naught simply because of the film's lousy plot. Right at the beginning of the film, the twist to happen in the end is already very obvious, and it seems that Malcolm Crowe, in spite of his doctorate degree and intensive experience in the field of psychology, is the only one who does not have a clue about what is going on. He does not recognize the fact that he was already dead even after months of roaming around; how could he be so blind not to notice that no one else can see and hear him save for Cole, who apparently has a sixth sense? His wife has never noticed his presence; the guy that she was seeing did not notice him either. Even Cole's mother never had a conversation with Malcolm where in fact, it is a protocol when dealing with children that professionals report their diagnosis to the parents. Such a display of naivete is very inconsistent with his character as a highly esteemed academic. Everything is such a giveaway, and many of the scenes violate even common sense knowledge.

Ask yourself the following questions:

Plot: Is the sequence of events logical and entertaining? Are there twists and turns in the story? What storytelling techniques were used?

5

Acting: Did the actors stay in character? Was their performance compelling? Did they project their voices well?

Cinematography: Do the shots contribute to the overall mood or theme the director wishes to convey?

Ask yourself the following questions:

5

Musical Score: Does the background music enhance the film's atmosphere?

Special Effects: Were there special effects in the movie? Were they appropriate and aesthetically pleasing?

Editing: Were the scenes logically arranged? Were there any unnecessary scenes?

Script: Were the lines natural for the characters and context? Is the dialogue original and catchy, or is it filled with clichés?

5

6. I am giving The Sixth Sense two out of five stars. While good acting is evident in the film, I believe that it does not possess the very purpose of a thriller, which is to “thrill” or surprise people. From the very beginning of the movie, the twist was already a giveaway, and that makes for a sloppy production.

SHORT QUIZ

1. What is the primary purpose of the first part of a reaction paper?

A. To provide a personal opinion and emotional response to the work.

B. To present an objective, factual summary that identifies the author and title.

C. To critique the author's background and previous publications.

D. To list every minor detail and subplot found in the material.

SHORT QUIZ

2. When writing the "Reaction" portion of the paper, what should a student focus on to make the content "thought-provoking"?

A. Simply stating whether they liked or disliked the work.

B. Copying the summary from the first paragraph to ensure length.

C. Connecting the work to course concepts, real-world issues, or personal experiences.

D. Avoiding any disagreement with the author's original thesis.

SHORT QUIZ

3. Why is a reaction paper compared to a scientific journal commentary?

A. Because it requires a professional dialogue that adds new value or perspective to the topic.

B. Because it must contain complex mathematical data and lab results.

C. Because it is intended to be read only by scientists and professors.

D. Because it should be at least twenty pages long to be considered academic.

SHORT QUIZ

4. Which of the following is a "don't" when writing the summary section of a reaction paper?

A. Using direct quotations to illustrate important ideas.

B. Highlighting the main points and key supporting evidence.

C. Including the publisher and publication date in the introduction.

D. Discussing one single aspect in great detail while neglecting other important points.

SHORT QUIZ

5. What is the benefit of creating a detailed outline before writing a reaction paper?

A. It helps the writer identify their specific reactions and organize supporting justifications.

B. It eliminates the need to read the material thoroughly.

C. It serves as the final draft of the paper so no further writing is needed.

D. It allows the writer to skip the introduction and move straight to the conclusion.

SHORT QUIZ

ANSWERS:

1. B
2. C
3. A
4. D
5. A

ASSIGNMENT

Directions: Read "My Father Goes to Court" by Carlos Bulosan and create a draft of a reaction paper. The draft must include the following sections: (20 points)

Title

Thesis Statement

Introduction: A paragraph consisting of 3–5 sentences.

Body: A skeleton draft with at least 3–5 sentences per point/reaction/opinion. Use bullet points and include citations where necessary.

Conclusion: A concluding summary (a recommendation is optional) that is also 3-5 sentences long.

References: List all sources cited using APA 7th Edition format.

ASSIGNMENT

Document Formatting:
Paper Size: Short bond paper (8.5" x 11")
Font: Times New Roman, Size 12
Alignment: Justified
Spacing: 1.5 line spacing

Example:

TITLE OF THE REACTION PAPER
[Your Name]

Introduction

Indent all paragraph beginnings. Make sure that your introduction completely states the author, the summary of the story, and your stand/reaction. Include your main idea and thesis statement.

Body

- This is where your first reaction/stand/opinion goes. Justify in 3-5 sentences with reference/proof/evidence as to why you chose this opinion/stand.
- This is where your second reaction/stand/opinion goes. Justify in 3-5 sentences with reference/proof/evidence as to why you chose this opinion/stand.
- This is where your second reaction/stand/opinion goes so on and so forth…

Conclusion

Summarize all the points you have laid out. Recommending the story is optional. Always indent the beginning of your paragraphs.

References

Mañibo, M. (2026). Reaction paper 101. *English for Academic and Professional Purposes for Senior High*. https://www.eappshs-resources.com/reaction-paper-101

Criteria	Excellent (5 pts)	Satisfactory (3 pts)	Developing (2pts)	Beginning (1pt)
Thesis and Introduction	Clear, insightful thesis. The intro is 3-5 sentences and sets the context perfectly.	Thesis is present but too general. Intro meets the length but lacks flow.	The thesis is vague or missing. The intro is too short or unrelated.	No intro or thesis provided.
Body Content (Skeleton)	Strong reactions/opinions with 3-5 sentences per bullet. Shows a deep analysis and understanding of the story.	Bullets meet the length requirements, but analysis is mostly summary.	The reactions/opinions are too short, or it lacks clear opinions/points.	Body section is missing or incomplete.
Grammar and Style	No errors in grammar, spelling, or punctuation.	Minor errors that do not hinder understanding.	Frequent errors that made the draft difficult to read.	Poor grammar throughout.
Technical Formatting	Followed all the instructions.	Missed 1 formatting requirement.	Missed 2 or more formatting requirements.	Did not follow formatting instructions at all.